MILENA COSTA

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LinkedIn · GitHub · Website

No current or future visa sponsorship required



RESEARCH PROFILE

My background in psychology and statistics equips me to bridge substantive social questions with rigorous methodology, from measurement and psychometrics to multilevel and network analysis.

EDUCATION

MSc Statistics & Data Science – Leiden University September 2024 – July 2026

Specialisation in Official Statistics (EMOS)

Thesis: The Contexts that Bind Us: Networks, Multiplexity, and Embeddedness in Institutional Domains (grade 8.0)

BSc Psychology – Maastricht University August 2021 – July 2024

Thesis: Expanding the Job Demands-Resources Model: The Work Dynamics Model (work–life balance; grade 8.5)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Master's Thesis Intern – Centraal Bureau voor de Statistiek (CBS) January 2026 – June 2026

- Developed an adjusted multiplexity measure to correct for administrative overlap between family and household registers, reducing estimated prevalence from 81.3% to 23.8%.
- Linked a whole-population multilayer network (∼17 million Dutch residents) to survey data (N = 28,483) to examine how the organisation of social ties across institutional domains relates to generalised trust, a key indicator of social cohesion.
- Currently collaborating on a CBS discussion paper based on the thesis and presenting the research at the ODISSEI Conference in November 2026.
- Built a reproducible R pipeline (data.table, DuckDB, Arrow) for large-scale network computation.

Statistical Consulting Project – Leiden University September 2025 – January 2026

- Applied multilevel GLMMs to assess how peer norms shaped children's pro-environmental effort choices; identified ceiling effects that informed task-design recommendations for the client.
- Developed a size-adjusted network density measure of classroom cohesion from peer-nomination data.

Research Project – Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam September 2023 – November 2023

- Contextualised and evaluated a brief self-report measure of well-being for workplace settings, examining its factor structure, reliability, and construct validity.

Research Project – Maastricht University April 2023 – July 2023

- Conducted a three-condition experiment on mental-health stigma; exploratory analyses indicated lower stigma following a written narrative and lower anger following a video.

SKILLS

Statistical methods: Psychometrics (scale validation, factor analysis, IRT, DIF), longitudinal and mixed-effects modelling, GLMs, SEM, survey methodology, statistical learning, Bayesian methods, network analysis

Programming: R (e.g., psych, mirt, lavaan, lme4, igraph), Python, Git/GitHub, LaTeX, SPSS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Dutch (B2+, current university course toward C1), Spanish (B1)

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Volunteer Coordinator – Studium Generale, Maastricht University 2022 – 2024

Coordinated 80+ volunteers across three editions of the Pleasure, Art & Science Festival.

Student Assistant – School of Business and Economics, Maastricht University 2022 – 2024

Screened 1,000+ student applications.

Student Ambassador – Faculty of Psychology and Neuroscience, Maastricht University 2022 – 2024

Represented the psychology programme at recruitment events.

Au Pair and Volunteer – Antwerp, Belgium 2019 – 2021

Childcare work; volunteered in elderly care and assisted at a COVID-19 vaccination centre.